

Garison High School Career Day

Exploring a career in Technology

David Young, Principal Software Engineer @ Thomson Reuters

Who is David

- Software Engineer for 11+ years
- Raised in Center, TX
- Graduate of SFASU, '14
- Husband to Lauren, and Dad to Ruby and Bennie



What is a Software Engineer?

- Creates and maintains programs of all kinds
- Games, browser based programs, desktop, phones, and server
- Involves a lot of problem solving and trying to turn ideas into things you can use.

What do I do?

- Principal Engineer in a Research and Development Organization
- Primarily responsible for a platform that reads documents
- Coaching other software engineers
- Set organizational technical strategy across several projects

Day in the Life

- Begins with email and making a plan for the day
- Morning - Meetings & Planning with EU colleagues
- Squeeze in a lunch, sometimes at home or on the go
- Afternoon - Coding, planning, meetings with NA colleagues
- Finish out the day with a list of priorities for tomorrow

Ok cool, what else is there in Tech?

- Product Management
- Data Science
- Design
- System Engineering
- IT Administration
- Engineering Management
- Customer Success/Account Managers/Sales

Why start a career in tech?

- Money 
- New problems every day, rarely stale 
- Opportunities to work from home 
- Diverse groups of people from all walks of life 
- Every industry is becoming a technology industry 

How to get started

- Focus on problem solving
- Get curious online, tons of great content on youtube. Check out Python!
- Build something small
- Don't be afraid to break things!

What are some of the downsides?

- New problems every day 😂
- Occassional long hours, especially if you are on call 📞
- Periods of stress when aiming to hit a deadline for a release 🕒
- Challenging to get everyone on the same page and goal 📄

My Journey

- In high school I really didn't know what I wanted to do
- When do you think I got my first job? What was it?

Early Career Timeline

- Job 1 (15): Janitor at a doctor's office
- Job 2 (16): Makin' popcorn at the Rio Theater!
- Job 3 (17 - 18): Part-Time computer tech for CISC
- Job 4 (18 - 19): Barista
 - started school at Panola College
- Job 5 (19 - 21): Computer Tech for SFASU
 - started school at SFASU, majoring in IT
- Job 6 (22): Software Engineer while finishing up college

Questions!

